COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FLOSS, DENTAL

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification FFF-F-486B which is being cancelled.

The commercial item description covers three types and two shapes of dental floss.

Salient characteristics:

General. The floss shall be suitable for use in dental operative procedures and in preventative dentistry. The types and shapes of dental floss shall be as follows:

Type I - Waxed

Shape 1 - Round
Shape 2 - Tape

Type II - Bonded

Shape 1 - Round

Type III - Natural

Shape 1 - Round

Type I floss shall be waxed nylon yarn. Type II floss shall be a yarn bonded with a colorless nylon polymer. Type III floss shall be natural (unwaxed and unbonded) nylon yarn. Shape 1 floss shall have a round cross section. Shape 2 floss shall have a flat tape cross section.

AMSC N/A FSC 6520

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Material. The yarn shall be natural, white dental floss, made of bright, high tenacity, continuous, multi-filament nylon. Material identification for nylon shall be in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard D276. The wax used for Type I floss shall be White Wax, National Formulary (NF), or Yellow Wax (NF), or highly refined petroleum wax, or combination of the aforementioned waxes. The petroleum wax used shall have a melting temperature between 135^0 Fahrenheit(F) and 180^0F when tested in accordance with USP.

When heated, the petroleum wax shall reduce to a clear, colorless liquid free from foreign particles which shall be observed for at the conclusion of the melting temperature test. The wax content shall be 12 to 30 percent for Type I, shape 1, and 20 to 40 percent for Type 1, shape 2, respectively, when tested as specified under wax content. The bonding agent used in Type II, shape 1 floss and as an alternate, for Type III, shape 1 floss, shall be a colorless nylon polymer suitable for use in the oral cavity.

Physical properties. The floss shall conform to the requirements of table I for number of filaments, denier of ends, yarn twist and floss minimum individual length for the applicable type and shape. The flat tape cross section for shape 2 floss shall be 1/16 to 1/32 inch in width.

The minimum average breaking strength shall be as specified in table I for the applicable types and shapes when tested in accordance with ASTM D2256.

Table I. Physical Characteristics

Type	Shape	No. of Filaments Per End 3/	Denier of end	Denier of yarn	Yarntwist (t.p.i)	Breaking Strength (pounds) minimum	Floss Min. Length (yard) 4/
I	1	30-38	30-100	790-880 1/	1-3	9	190
I	2	30-38	20-140	1330-1470 1/	1 max	16.5	95
II	1	136-144	875-970	875-970 2/	1-3	9	190
III	1	26-38	70-140	470-560	1-3	6	95

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1/ Denier of yarn shall be established prior to wax coating.

2/ Denier of yarn shall be established prior to bonding.

3/ As as alternate, 45-55 number of filaments per end for all types shall be acceptable.

4/ The floss shall be furnished in one continuous length.

Put-up Floss shall be uniformly wound on a spool so that the floss unwinds from the outer diameter and each turn and layer is free from entanglement. The floss shall be provided in one continuous length. Types I and II floss shall be furnished as refill items suitable for use in a bracket dispenser. The floss shall be uniformly wound on a cylindrical spool fabricated of rigid plastic, or rigid cardboard, 2-3/4 ± 1/16 inches in length and 5/16 ± 1/32 inch in diameter. The floss shall be wound on the core to a maximum diameter of 1-1/8 inches in such a manner that a minimum of 3/16 inch of the core is exposed on each end of the fully wound spool. The floss shall dispense without snarling or entanglement when inserted in a dispenser in accordance with A-A-51539 and tested as specified in test section under dispensing of floss.

Type III. Unless otherwise specified, the floss shall be furnished in a plastic or metal dispenser. The dispenser shall contain the spool of floss and shall have a cap or lid for opening and closing, or as an alternate, shall be a sealed dispenser, except for the friction-fit cover cutting device. The dispenser shall have an opening through which the floss may be pulled out and a built-in corrosion resistant metal holding and cutting device for securing and cutting the floss. The floss shall dispense without snarling or entanglement when tested as specified in test section under dispensing of floss. When specified, the type I or II floss shall be furnished in the put-up as specified for the type III floss.

Workmanship. The floss shall be clean and packaged clean with no dirty spots or stains clearly visible or noticeable. There shall be no objectionable odor or taste present in the floss. The floss shall be free from lumps, knots, kinks, fuzziness, fraying, tangling, or non-smooth surfaces, and other imperfections which may detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

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Unit. Package (PG). One package containing twenty-four spools for Type I or Type II dental floss or one package containing 36 spools for Type III, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties of the item.

Test.

Wax content. A 10-yard sample of floss shall be weighed. The sample shall then be soaked in a wax solvent such as ethanol until all of the wax has been removed, as determined by the sample arriving at an equilibrium of constant weight. After all of the solvent has been dried off the sample, it shall be reweighed and the percent of wax content calculated as follows:

Percent of wax content =

$$\frac{\text{Weight of sample} - \text{Weight of unwaxed sample} \times 100}{\text{Weight of sample}}$$

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A minimum of two determinations shall be made and the results averaged.

Dispensing floss. A minimum of 3 yards of the floss shall be pulled from the container. The floss shall be examined during and after dispensing for tangles or snarls. A minimum of two determinations shall be made.

Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Where feasible, the same shall be used for the determination of two or more inspection characteristics. The unit of product for inspection purposes shall be one unit of issue, as specified. Sampling for tests shall be conducted at inspection level S-1, AQL 2.5. The sampling for examination shall be conducted at inspection level S-2 and AQL 2.5. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with the following list of defects. Examination shall include but not limited to the defects listed.

Defects

Nylon not continuous filament nylon.

Core, spool, or reel on which floss is wound not smooth.

Floss improperly or not firmly wound on core, spool or reel.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the the salient characteristics of this description and conform to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric Products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting of rejecting the product.

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE 1: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

Stock Number	Item Identification	Designation	Shape
6520-00-935-1007	FLOSS, UNWAXED, DENTAL, Nylon, Extra Fine, 100 yards, 36's.	III	1
6520-01-063-6875	FLOSS, UNWAXED, DENTAL, 200 yards, 24's.	II	1
6520-01-063-7477	FLOSS, UNWAXED, DENTAL Flat Tape, 100 yards, 24's.	I	2
6520-01-063-7478	FLOSS, WAXED, DENTAL, 200 yards, 24's.	I	1

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NOTE 2: The following National Stock Number represents the floss dispenser for Type I Dental Floss.

Stock Number	Item Identification
6520-00-890-1871	DISPENSER, DENTAL, FLOSS, Metal

NOTE 3: Denier. Denier is defined as the weight in grams of 9000 meters of yarn, e.g. a 200 denier nylon yarn is one wherein 9000 meters of yarn weighs 200 grams.

Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be as specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA - DM

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:
VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6520-2106

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53652	FLOSS, DENTAL

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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